Math 393 Syllabus

Math 393: Abstract Algebra

Professor: Geoffrey Buhl
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Office: 2324 Marin Hall
Office hours: MW 9:00–10:00am or by appointment
Course meetings: Monday and Wednesday, 10:30–11:45am
Course textbook: Abstract Algebra: Theory and Applications, Thomas W. Judson
Course website: CI Learn

Math 393 Specific Information

Why I like this course

Groups, rings, and fields! Oh My! These are the core algebraic structures in mathematics. Finally we get to the good stuff: axiomatic mathematics and discussing the rules and structures that are the baseline tools for all of mathematics. Groups describe symmetry and have rich and interesting structure that arise from 3 simple axioms.

Course Description

Prerequisite: MATH 240 and MATH 310

Groups, rings, and fields, the basic algebraic structures in contemporary mathematics.

How to contact me

The best way to get in touch with me is in-person or by email. In general, if you have any difficulties with the material, schedule, or anything else, get in touch with me. I'm here to help, and it's much easier to help if you are proactive. If my office hours don't work for you, email me and we can work out a time to me in-person or via Zoom.

Student Learning Outcomes

- Discuss the basic algebraic structures appearing in mathematics today
- Apply the knowledge of these structures to the analysis of concrete special cases
- Compute degrees of extensions
- Prove impossibility of certain ruler and compass geometric constructions, e.g. squaring of the circle
- Parametrize field extensions by groups and vice-versa
- Determine the solvability of higher degree polynomial equations by radicals
- Express concepts and techniques of Abstract Algebra in oral and written form

Course Workload

This is a 3 credit hour course, which means that students should be prepared to spend 9 hours a week on work related to this class outside of class. Spending time throughout the week working on homework is critical for a successful learning experience.

Student Evaluation Structure

Component	Points
Homework	200
Midterm	100
Proof Portfolio	100
Final Exam	200
Total	**600**

Percent	Grade
100-90	A
89-80	B
79-70	C
69-60	D

Percent	Grade
59-0	F

I will assign + and - grades in this course at my discretion. The grade book on CILearn will be used to record and track your scores. There will be a few small opportunities for extra credit.

Homework is due by 11:59pm on the Friday due date. Late homework will have the total score reduced by 2.5% for each day that the homework is late up for to 20 days. Homework that is over 20 day late will not be graded. Submit your assignments as PDFs or JPEGs through CI Learn. Please take care to write up your work clearly and to submit PDFs that are easy to read. Many students successfully use CamScanner or Adobe Scan apps for their phones to create PDFs to upload. There are nine homework scores the lowest score will be dropped.

Educational Opportunities

If you have special educational opportunities, like traveling for a conference, going to Santa Rosa Island, participating in an academic competition that would cause you to miss class, *I strongly encourage you to take part in these special opportunities.* Please let me know in advance, and we can work together on a plan to address any missed learning.

Collaboration Policy

Working in groups on the homework assignment is strongly encouraged. However each person should individually write up their solutions, relying only on their notes about the problem. On each homework assignment, please indicate which students you worked with. An important part of mathematical culture and work is acknowledging the people that helped you understand and solve a problem.

Additional Resources

Office hours is a time when you can come to my office and ask me questions about course material. Students who make use of office hours tend to do better in college courses. You are encouraged to make early and regular use of **campus tutors** in the LRC. For campus tutoring locations, subjects and hours, use this link.

Class Schedule

Week	Date	Chapter	Notes
1	Aug 24		Course Introduction
1	Aug 26	1 & 2	Equivalence Relations and Division Algorithm
2	Aug 31	3.1	Integer Equivalence Classes and Symmetries
2	Sep 2	3.2	Definitions and Examples of Groups
3	Sep 7		**Labor Day** - Campus Closed
3	Sep 9	3.3	Subgroups
4	Sep 14	3	
4	Sep 16	4.1	Cyclic Subgroups
5	Sep 21	4.2	Multiplicative Group of Complex Numbers
5	Sep 23	5.1	Definitions and Notation of Permutation Groups
6	Sep 28	5.2	Dihedral Groups
6	Sep 30	6.1	Cosets
7	Oct 5	6.2	Lagrange's Theorem
7	Oct 7	6.3	Fermat's and Euler's Theorems
8	Oct 12	6	
8	Oct 14		**Midterm**
9	Oct 19	9.1	Definition and Examples of Isomorphisms
9	Oct 21	9.2	Direct Products
10	Oct 26	10.1	Factor Groups and Normal Subgroups
10	Oct 28	10.2	Simplicity of the Alternating Group
11	Nov 2	10	
11	Nov 4	11.1	Group Homomorphisms
12	Nov 9	11.2	Isomorphism Theorems
12	Nov 13		**Veterans Day** - Campus Closed
13	Nov 16	11	
13	Nov 18	16.1	Rings
14	Nov 23	16.2	Integral Domains and Fields
14	Nov 25	16.3	Ring Homomorphisms and Ideals
15	Nov 30	16.4	Maximal and Prime Ideals
15	Dec 2	16	
	Dec 9		**Final Exam** 8:00AM - 10:00AM

CSU Channel Islands Information

Degree Planning

During Week 3 of classes of each semester, you are asked to update your information in the degree planner. The degree planner is a useful tool to help you stay on track toward achieving your goal of graduation. Students can learn how to update the degree planner using information provided here.

In Case of Disruption

Wildfires and COVID are example of big disruptions that affect us all. There are smaller ones, like the class I wasn't able to teach because my second child was being born or when students have to help their family members. Events big and small can affect our ability to be in class, but the goal to make sure learning keeps happening.

So, yes disruptions big and small happen! A disruption means you, me, or all of us cannot participate in 'class as usual' for a reason we could not predict at the beginning of the semester. After COVID-19, we are well aware that disruption can happen fast. While we hope to avoid any closures due to COVID related reasons, let's face it, disruption happens every semester. You may get sick, I may get sick, or campus may close due to a wildfire - this is California after all. Life happens! Our goal as a learning community is to do our best to keep teaching and learning with as little interruption as possible. This page explains what you can expect from me and what I expect from you when facing disruption - small or big!

If I am out: If for whatever reason I am unable to be on campus, I will move lectures to a zoom format, which will be communicated by the announcement in this course. I will record these lecture and post them as well.

If you are out: Be proactive and communicate! I will always work with you to figure out how to help you keep learning! I have old lectures and notes that are recorded that I can share, if that is what is needed. If you just need a little extra time to get something done, let me know, I will always grant you a few more days on assignments.

If campus closes: If all of campus closes, which has happened at least once over the last three or more academic years, we will move to Zoom classes which I will also record and post in the pages for each class. I will communicate changes to the course schedule or other changes by using announcements in CILearn. More details can be found on the "Disruption Plan" page for this course on CI Learn.

Important note about a possible work stoppage during the semester

The California Faculty Association (the union that represents all CSU faculty, including lecturer faculty, tenure-line faculty, coaches, counselors, and librarians) is in the midst of a difficult contract dispute with the CSU system-wide administration. In response to the CSU management's stance, it is possible that the faculty union will call a strike or other work stoppage this term. I promise to inform the class as soon as possible of any disruption to our class meeting schedule.

Accommodations

If you are a student with a disability requesting reasonable accommodations in this course, please visit Disability Accommodations and Support Services (DASS) located on the second floor of Arroyo Hall, or call 805-437-3331. All requests for reasonable accommodations require registration with DASS in advance of need. You can apply for DASS services here. Faculty, students and DASS will work together regarding classroom accommodations. You are encouraged to discuss approved accommodations with your faculty.

Civil Discourse Statement

All students, staff and faculty on our campus are expected to join in making our campus a safe space for communication and civil discourse. If you are experiencing discomfort related to the language you are hearing or seeing on campus (in or out of classes), please talk with a trusted faculty or staff member. Similarly, please consider whether the language that you are using (in person or on Canvas) respects the rights of others to engage in informed discourse and express a diversity of opinions freely and in a civil manner (language from Academic Senate Resolution SR 16-01, Commitment to Equity, Inclusion, and Civil Discourse within our Diverse Campus Community).

Basic Needs at CI

If you face challenges securing food, housing, or other basic needs, you are not alone, and CSUCI wants to help during this time of crisis. One helpful resource is the community of staff available through the Basic Needs Program (BNP) located on the first floor of Arroyo Hall, Room 114. Students can call 805-437-2067, email basicneeds@csuci.edu, or drop in during open hours and talk with a BNP student assistant or professional staff member for resources, ideas, and strategies connected to basic needs challenges. Students can complete a referral form to request services for themselves or others by going to www.csuci.edu/basicneeds. The BNP is known for the Dolphin Pantry located at Arroyo Hall 114, but there are other resources available and staff who can help you work through housing insecurity or displacement as well as financial insecurity. Undergraduate students living in California are especially encouraged to explore CalFresh (grocery money each month for eligible students) as a resource. Domestic undergraduate students living in California are likely to be eligible for CalFresh and BNP staff are skilled with helping students navigate this process.

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS)

CAPS is pleased to provide a wide range of services to assist students in achieving their academic and personal goals. Services include confidential short-term counseling, crisis intervention, psychiatric consultation, and 24/7 phone counseling. CAPS is located in Bell Tower East, 1867

and can be reached at 805-437-2088 (select option 1 on voicemail for 24/7 phone counseling); you can also email us at caps@csuci.edu or visit our website at https://www.csuci.edu/caps.

Academic Honesty

By enrolling at CSU Channel Islands, students are responsible for upholding the University's policies and the Student Conduct Code. Academic integrity and scholarship are values of the institution that ensure respect for the academic reputation of the University, students, faculty, and staff. Cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration with another student, knowingly furnishing false information to the University, buying, selling or stealing any material for an examination, or substituting for another person may be considered violations of the Student Conduct Code (located at http://www.csuci.edu/campuslife/student-conduct/academic-dishonesty.htm). If a student is found responsible for committing an act of academic dishonesty in this course, the student may receive academic penalties including a failing grade on an assignment or in the course, and a disciplinary referral will be made and submitted to the Dean of Students office. For additional information, please see the faculty Academic Senate Policy on Academic Dishonesty, also in the CI Catalog. Please ask about my expectations regarding academic dishonesty in this course if they are unclear.

Basically what this boils down to is: the work that you submit for credit should be your own work and reflect your understanding of the course material. Group work, collaborations, and the free exchange of ideas are fundamental aspects of an academic environment. I encourage you all to talk and work with others in the class, as it will enhance your understanding of the material. You must write up your assignment individually and explain solutions in your own words. It is also important to cite resources you used in work, these may include other students, books, websites, and instructors.

There is a distinction between collaboration and copying. Collaboration is encouraged; copying solutions or assignments is not allowed. If I find copying of solutions on an assignment it will result in a score of 0 on that assignment. Multiple instances of academic dishonesty will be formally documented with the University.

Academic Honesty and Generative AI: I have begun to notice students submitting work generated by AI. This is copying. If I suspect AI has been used on an assignment, I will assign a score of 0, but you can present your work in office hours or by appointment to receive credit.

Disclaimer on syllabus changes

Information on this syllabus is subject to change. I will make such changes known in class and on CI Learn.